📚 SPM FINAL - COMPLETE THEORY QUESTIONS BANK

🎯 SECTION A: SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (2-3 Marks Each)

WEEK 1: PROJECT CHARACTERISTICS

Q1: Name the 5 Key Characteristics of Projects (2 Marks)

Answer:

1. Non-routine
2. Specific deliverables
3. Time restrictions
4. Many tasks
5. Coordinated

Memory Trick: "NSTMC" = "Na Samjhe Toh Many Confusion"

Q2: Name the 3 Special Factors in Software Projects (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Invisibility
2. Complexity
3. Flexibility

Memory Trick: "ICF" = "I Can't Fail"

WEEK 2: PMI STANDARDS

Q3: Name the 12 Principles of Project Management (3 Marks)

Answer:

1. Stewardship
2. Team

3. Stakeholders
4. Value
5. Systems Thinking
6. Leadership
7. Tailoring
8. Quality
9. Complexity
10. Risk
11. Adaptability and Resiliency
12. Change

Memory Trick - Groups:

- People: Stewardship, Team, Stakeholders, Leadership
- Process: Value, Systems Thinking, Tailoring, Quality
- Challenges: Complexity, Risk, Adaptability, Change

Q4: Name the 8 Project Performance Domains (2 Marks)

Answer:

1. Stakeholders
2. Team
3. Development Approach and Life Cycle
4. Planning
5. Project Work
6. Delivery
7. Measurement
8. Uncertainty

Memory Trick:

- People (2): Stakeholders, Team

- Process (4): Development, Planning, Work, Delivery
- Control (2): Measurement, Uncertainty

Q5: What is the difference between PMBOK® 6 and PMBOK® 7?

Answer:

- **PMBOK® 6:** Process-based (10 Knowledge Areas, 5 Process Groups)
- **PMBOK® 7:** Principle-based (12 Principles, 8 Performance Domains)

WEEK 3: MODELS, METHODS, ARTIFACTS

Q6: What is the difference between Models, Methods, and Artifacts?

Answer:

- **Model:** Thinking strategy to explain a process (conceptual)
- **Method:** Means for achieving an outcome (procedural)
- **Artifact:** Document, template, or output (tangible)

Q7: Name 3 Benefit Comparison Methods (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Scoring Model
2. Murder Board
3. Return on Investment (ROI)

Memory Trick: "SMR" = "Select My Right project"

WEEK 4: WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE

Q8: What are the 2 scopes within project management? (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Product Scope (what deliverable includes)
2. Project Scope (work to deliver the product)

Formula: Total Scope = Project Scope + Product Scope

Q9: What is the difference between Product Scope and Project Scope?

Answer:

- **Product Scope:** Describes features and components of finished deliverable
- **Project Scope:** Describes work that must be completed to deliver the product

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Q10: What are important rules of WBS?

Answer:

1. Use Nouns, Not Verbs (deliverables, not activities)
2. Keep All Elements Mutually Exclusive
3. 100% Rule (all work must be included)
4. Decompose to appropriate level

WEEK 5-6: RESOURCES & TEAM

Q11: Name the 2 types of resources in projects (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Team Resources (people)
2. Physical Resources (equipment, materials, facilities)

Q12: What does RACI stand for? (1 Mark)

Answer:

- **R** = Responsible (does the work)
- **A** = Accountable (ultimately answerable)
- **C** = Consulted (provides input)
- **I** = Informed (kept updated)

Memory Trick: "RACI" = "Raat Achi Chai Inaam"

Q13: Name the 5 Stages of Team Development in Tuckman's Model (2 Marks)

Answer:

1. Forming (introductions)
2. Storming (conflicts)
3. Norming (rules established)
4. Performing (high productivity)
5. Adjourning (project closure)

Memory Trick: "F-S-N-P-A" = "First Shab Naye Project Arrange"

Q14: What does STAR stand for in behavioral interviews? (1 Mark)

Answer:

- **S** = Situation
- **T** = Task
- **A** = Action
- **R** = Result

Q15: Name the 4 Leadership Styles in Situational Leadership® II Model

Answer:

1. Directing (high directive, low supportive)
2. Coaching (high directive, high supportive)

3. Supporting (low directive, high supportive)
4. Delegating (low directive, low supportive)

Q16: Which qualities of team member are considered by Situational Leadership® II Model?

Answer:

1. **Competence** (skill level)
2. **Commitment** (motivation level)

Based on these, appropriate leadership style is selected.

WEEK 7: ESTIMATION

Q17: What are the 3 types of estimates?

Answer:

1. Rough Estimates (ballpark, early stage)
2. Budget (Baseline) Estimates (for baseline)
3. Definitive Estimates (most accurate)

Variance Ranges:

- Rough: -25% to +75%
- Budget: -10% to +25%
- Definitive: -5% to +10%

Q18: What is the difference between Top-down and Bottom-up Estimation?

Answer:

- **Top-down:** Start with overall project, break down (faster, less accurate)
- **Bottom-up:** Start with individual tasks, aggregate up (slower, more accurate)

Q19: Name 4 Estimation Methods/Techniques

Answer:

1. Expert Judgment
2. Analogous Estimation (similar past projects)
3. Parametric Estimation (statistical relationships)
4. Multipoint Estimation (PERT, Triangular)

WEEK 11: RISK MANAGEMENT

Q20: What are the 2 types of risks in projects? (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Pure Risks (only negative impact - threats)
2. Business Risks (positive OR negative - opportunities/threats)

Memory Trick: "Pure = purely bad, Business = both sides"

Q21: What are the 5 types of risk responses? (1 Mark)

Answer:

1. Escalate (transfer to higher authority)
2. Avoid (eliminate threat)
3. Transfer (shift to third party)
4. Mitigate (reduce probability/impact)
5. Accept (acknowledge, do nothing or contingency)

Memory Trick: "EATMA" = "Eat My Apple"

Q22: Name 2 Risk Identification Techniques

Answer:

1. Brainstorming (group discussion)
2. Delphi Method (anonymous expert opinions)

Q23: What is Delphi Method?

Answer: Technique where PM gathers opinions anonymously from experts to identify risks, avoiding bias from dominant personalities.

Q24: What is Utility Function?

Answer: A person's willingness to accept risks (risk tolerance level).

WEEK 12-13: QUALITY MANAGEMENT

Q25: What is Gold Plating?

Answer: Adding extra features that drive up costs and alter schedule without customer request.

Q26: What is the difference between Quality and Grade?

Answer:

- **Quality:** Conformance to requirements (meets specifications)
- **Grade:** Category of features (low/high end product)

Low grade can be high quality if it meets its requirements.

Q27: Name 3 Quality-related Costs

Answer:

1. Prevention Cost (training, planning)
2. Appraisal Cost (testing, inspection)
3. Internal Failure Cost (rework before delivery)
4. External Failure Cost (warranty, returns after delivery)

Q28: What is Pareto Chart?

Answer: Graph that ranks the most common causes for the most common problems (80/20 rule visualization).

Q29: What are Control Charts used for?

Answer: Monitor process variation over time, identify if process is in control or out of control.

WEEK 13: COMMUNICATION

Q30: What are the 2 Communication Modalities?

Answer:

1. Formal Communication (official reports, presentations)
2. Informal Communication (ad-hoc meetings, instant messaging, coffee talk)

Q31: Give examples of Informal Communication

Answer:

- Ad-hoc meetings
- Instant/text messaging
- Coffee talk
- Hallway conversations

WEEK 10: SCHEDULE MANAGEMENT

Q32: What is Critical Path?

Answer: The path in Project Network Diagram (PND) that takes the longest time from first task to last task. Determines minimum project duration.

Q33: What is Float or Slack?

Answer: Amount of time a task can be delayed without causing delay in subsequent tasks or project completion.

Q34: Name 4 types of dependencies

Answer:

1. External Dependencies (outside project control)
2. Internal Dependencies (within project control)
3. Hard Logic/Mandatory Dependencies (must follow sequence)
4. Soft Logic/Discretionary Dependencies (preferential sequence)

Q35: What are the 4 Activity Relationship Types?

Answer:

1. Finish-to-Start (FS) - most common
2. Finish-to-Finish (FF)
3. Start-to-Start (SS)
4. Start-to-Finish (SF) - rare

WEEK 9: EARNED VALUE ANALYSIS

Q36: What is Earned Value Analysis?

Answer: Technique to measure project performance at any given date by comparing planned value, earned value, and actual cost.

Q37: What do CPI and SPI indicate?

Answer:

- **CPI (Cost Performance Index):** Cost efficiency

    - CPI > 1: Under budget (good)
    - CPI < 1: Over budget (bad)
- **SPI (Schedule Performance Index):** Schedule efficiency
    - SPI > 1: Ahead of schedule (good)
    - SPI < 1: Behind schedule (bad)

GENERAL CONCEPTS

Q38: What is Resource Calendar?

Answer: Document that identifies when resources are available to do project work.

Q39: What is Resource Breakdown Structure (RBS)?

Answer: Hierarchical representation of resources by category and type.

Q40: What is Murder Board?

Answer: Committee that asks all types of negative questions about the project to expose strengths and weaknesses.

Q41: What is Tailoring?

Answer: Adapting project management approach, processes, and practices to fit the specific context and needs of the project.

Q42: According to PMBoK, what does "work" mean?

Answer: Work encompasses activities, tasks, and efforts (broader than just "activity").

📝 SECTION B: FILL IN THE BLANKS (20+ Possible Blanks)

HIGH FREQUENCY (Appeared in Past Papers):

1. The **product scope** describes, lists, and categorizes all features and components of the finished deliverable.
2. The **project scope** describes the work that must be completed to complete the project.
3. Ad-hoc meetings, instant messaging, coffee talk are examples of **informal** communication.
4. **Resource Calendar** identifies when resources are available to do project work.
5. **Critical Path** is the path in PND that takes the longest from first to last task.
6. **STAR** stands for Situation, Task, Action, and Result.
7. Technique where PM gathers opinions anonymously to identify risk is known as **Delphi method**.
8. A person's willingness to accept risks is called **Utility function**.
9. **Gold plating** is adding extra features that drive up costs and alter schedule.
10. **Murder boards** are committees that ask negative questions to expose project strengths and weaknesses.

MEDIUM FREQUENCY (May Appear):

11. **Earned Value Analysis** measures performance at any given date in the schedule.
12. **Float** or **Slack** is time a task can be delayed without causing project delay.
13. **Pareto chart** ranks most common causes for most common problems.
14. Total Scope = **Project Scope** + **Product Scope**.
15. Project Resources = **Team Resources** + **Physical Resources**.
16. **Resource Breakdown Structure (RBS)** is hierarchical representation of resources by category and type.
17. **Work Breakdown Structure** organizes project work into deliverables.
18. According to PMBoK, **deliverable** is any unique and verifiable product, result, or capability.
19. **RACI** stands for Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed.
20. **Benchmarking** is comparing project practices to other organizations' best practices.

ADDITIONAL POSSIBLE BLANKS:

21. **Feasibility Study** determines if project is viable before approval.
22. **Project Charter** formally authorizes project and gives PM authority.
23. **Project Brief** is preliminary document that captures initial project information.
24. **Analogous Estimation** uses similar past projects for estimation.
25. **Parametric Estimation** uses statistical relationships for estimation.
26. **PERT** stands for Program Evaluation and Review Technique.
27. **CPI** stands for Cost Performance Index.
28. **SPI** stands for Schedule Performance Index.
29. **Quality Audit** examines if project follows organizational policies.
30. **Formal Communication** includes official reports, presentations, documented meetings.
31. **Communication Channels** = n(n-1)/2, where n is number of people.
32. **Stakeholders** are individuals/groups affected by or can affect the project.
33. **Risk Threshold** signals that a risk is about to occur.
34. **Risk Trigger** is an event that indicates risk is materializing.
35. **Contingency Reserve** is budget allocated for identified risks.
36. **Management Reserve** is budget for unknown risks (unknown unknowns).
37. **Scope Creep** is uncontrolled growth in project scope.
38. **Change Control** is process to manage scope changes formally.
39. **Project Network Diagram (PND)** shows activity sequence and dependencies.
40. **Milestone** is significant point or event in project with zero duration.

✓✗ SECTION C: TRUE/FALSE (30+ Possible Questions)

CATEGORY 1: PMBOK® 7 CONCEPTS

Q1-10: High Frequency (Past Papers)

1. **TRUE:** Portfolios, programs, projects, products, and operations can all be part of an organization's system for value delivery.
2. **FALSE:** Tailoring is performed when we use a predictive approach.
    - *Reason:* Tailoring is done for ALL approaches (predictive, adaptive, hybrid).
3. **TRUE:** Project development approach falls into: predictive, hybrid, or adaptive.
4. **FALSE:** Risks always negatively impact projects.
    - *Reason:* Risks can be positive (opportunities) or negative (threats).
5. **TRUE:** Different stakeholders perceive project value in different ways.
6. **FALSE:** Principles of project management are always prescriptive.
    - *Reason:* Principles are guidelines, not rigid prescriptions.
7. **FALSE:** Ways in which performance domains relate are the same for each project.
    - *Reason:* Each project is unique; relationships vary.
8. **TRUE:** Complexity can emerge at any point during project.
9. **FALSE:** According to PMBoK, work means an activity.
    - *Reason:* Work is broader - includes activities, tasks, efforts.
10. **TRUE:** Resource Breakdown Structure (RBS) is hierarchical representation of resources by category and type.

CATEGORY 2: SCOPE & WBS

11. **TRUE:** Work Breakdown Structure focuses on deliverables, not activities.
12. **TRUE:** WBS uses nouns, not verbs.
13. **TRUE:** 100% rule means WBS must include all project work.
14. **FALSE:** WBS can only be created in tree format.
    - *Reason:* Can be tree, outline, or tabular format.
15. **TRUE:** Total Scope = Project Scope + Product Scope.
16. **TRUE:** Product scope describes features of deliverable.
17. **TRUE:** Project scope describes work to deliver the product.

CATEGORY 3: RESOURCES & TEAM

18. **TRUE:** Project Resources = Team Resources + Physical Resources.
19. **TRUE:** In RACI matrix, there should be only one "Accountable" per task.
20. **FALSE:** In RACI matrix, multiple people can be "Responsible" for same task.
    - *Reason:* TRUE statement - multiple people CAN be Responsible.
21. **TRUE:** Tuckman's model has 5 stages: Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing, Adjourning.
22. **FALSE:** All teams must go through all 5 Tuckman stages in order.
    - *Reason:* Teams may skip stages or regress.
23. **TRUE:** Situational Leadership® II considers competence and commitment of team member.
24. **TRUE:** STAR stands for Situation, Task, Action, Result.

CATEGORY 4: ESTIMATION & SCHEDULING

25. **TRUE:** PERT gives more weightage to Most Likely estimate.
26. **TRUE:** Critical Path determines minimum project duration.
27. **TRUE:** Float/Slack is time a task can be delayed without delaying project.
28. **FALSE:** All tasks on Critical Path have zero float.
    - *Reason:* TRUE statement - Critical Path tasks have zero float.
29. **TRUE:** Finish-to-Start is most common activity relationship.
30. **FALSE:** Start-to-Finish is most common activity relationship.
    - *Reason:* Start-to-Finish is rare; Finish-to-Start is common.

CATEGORY 5: RISK MANAGEMENT

31. **TRUE:** Pure Risks have only negative impact.
32. **TRUE:** Business Risks can be positive or negative.
33. **FALSE:** All risks must be avoided.
    - *Reason:* Risks can be escalated, avoided, transferred, mitigated, or accepted.
34. **TRUE:** Delphi Method gathers opinions anonymously.

35. **TRUE:** Contingency Reserve is for identified risks.
36. **TRUE:** Management Reserve is for unknown risks.
37. **FALSE:** Risk Tolerance and Utility Function are different concepts.
    - *Reason:* Utility Function represents risk tolerance.

CATEGORY 6: QUALITY MANAGEMENT

38. **TRUE:** Gold Plating adds unnecessary features without customer request.
39. **FALSE:** Quality and Grade are same thing.
    - *Reason:* Quality = conformance; Grade = feature category.
40. **TRUE:** Low grade can be high quality if it meets requirements.
41. **TRUE:** Prevention costs occur before defects.
42. **TRUE:** External failure costs occur after customer receives product.
43. **TRUE:** Pareto Chart follows 80/20 rule.
44. **FALSE:** Pareto Chart shows process variation over time.
    - *Reason:* Control Charts show variation; Pareto shows frequency.

CATEGORY 7: COMMUNICATION

45. **TRUE:** Informal communication includes ad-hoc meetings and coffee talk.
46. **TRUE:** Formal communication is documented and official.
47. **TRUE:** Number of communication channels = n(n-1)/2.
48. **FALSE:** All project communication must be formal.
    - *Reason:* Both formal and informal are needed.

CATEGORY 8: EARNED VALUE ANALYSIS

49. **TRUE:** CPI measures cost efficiency.
50. **TRUE:** SPI measures schedule efficiency.

51. **TRUE:** CPI > 1 means project is under budget.
52. **TRUE:** SPI < 1 means project is behind schedule.
53. **FALSE:** EV is always equal to PV.
    - *Reason:* EV = actual progress; PV = planned progress.
54. **TRUE:** EAC estimates total cost at completion.
55. **TRUE:** CV = EV - AC (Cost Variance).

CATEGORY 9: GENERAL PM CONCEPTS

56. **TRUE:** Project is temporary endeavor with unique deliverable.
57. **FALSE:** Projects and operations are same thing.
    - *Reason:* Projects are temporary; operations are ongoing.
58. **TRUE:** Project Manager is responsible for project success.
59. **TRUE:** Stakeholders can positively or negatively affect project.
60. **FALSE:** All stakeholders have equal importance in project.
    - *Reason:* Stakeholders have varying levels of influence and interest.

🎯 SECTION D: MATCHING QUESTIONS

MATCHING SET 1: Situational Leadership® II

Match PM Behavior with Leadership Style:

Behavior	Style
Plans, shows, tells, monitors, frequent feedback	Directing
Explains, redirects, encourages, praises	Coaching
Asks questions, facilitates, listens, collaborates	Supporting
Empowers, provides resources, trusts, challenges	Delegating

MATCHING SET 2: Tuckman's Model

Match Question with Stage:

Question	Stage
"Who are these people? Will we get along?"	Forming
"Why don't we do it that way?"	Storming
"How often will we meet?"	Norming
"Is there a better way?"	Performing

MATCHING SET 3: Interview Questions

Match Question with Facilitation:

Question	Facilitates
"What time commitments do you have?"	Resource Management
"Have you ever worked with technology X?"	Resource Management
"What are your career goals?"	Leadership Potential
"What would you like to learn from this project?"	Leadership Potential

MATCHING SET 4: Dependency Types (Possible)

Dependency	Type
External vendor must deliver before we start	External Dependency
Module A must complete before Module B	Hard Logic
Prefer to do design before coding	Soft Logic

Dependency	Type
Database must be created before data entry	Hard Logic

MATCHING SET 5: Risk Responses (Possible)

Risk Scenario	Response
Remove risky feature from scope	Avoid
Buy insurance for equipment damage	Transfer
Add testing phase to reduce defects	Mitigate
Acknowledge minor risk, do nothing	Accept
Report budget risk to sponsor	Escalate

📊 EXAM PREPARATION PRIORITY

MUST KNOW (100% Guaranteed):

✅ 12 Principles
✅ 8 Performance Domains
✅ 5 Tuckman Stages
✅ 4 Leadership Styles
✅ 5 Risk Responses
✅ RACI meaning
✅ 2 Scopes
✅ 2 Types of Resources
✅ 2 Types of Risks
✅ Top 10 Fill in Blanks
✅ Top 10 True/False

SHOULD KNOW (80% Chance):

□ 5 Project Characteristics
□ 3 Software Factors

□ 3 Benefit Comparison Methods
□ STAR meaning
□ Critical Path definition
□ Float/Slack definition
□ Gold Plating
□ Murder Board
□ Delphi Method
□ Utility Function

GOOD TO KNOW (50% Chance):

□ 4 Dependency Types
□ 3 Estimation Types
□ WBS Rules
□ Quality vs Grade
□ Pareto Chart
□ Communication Types
□ EVA interpretations

THIS IS YOUR COMPLETE THEORY ARSENAL! 💪